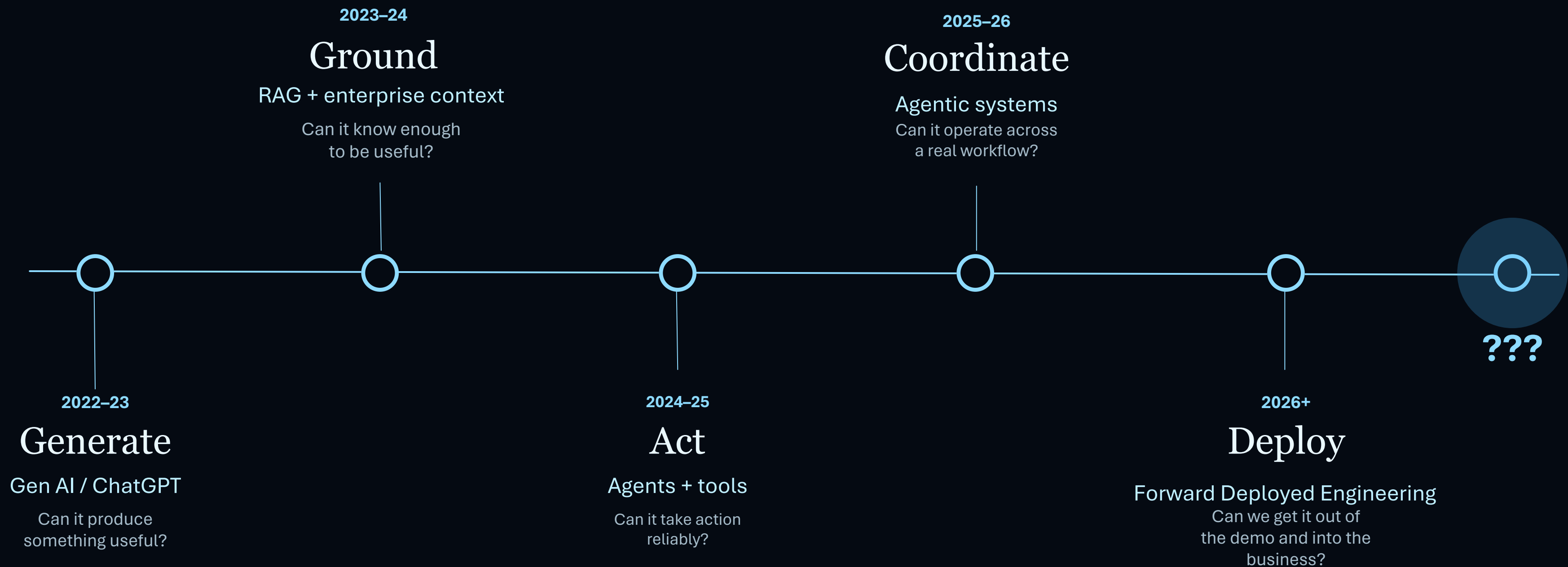


Outcome Engineering

Why Your Agentic Architecture
Doesn't Matter(Yet)

As technology keeps advancing, the bottleneck keeps moving.



Every step added capability. Every step also added more to integrate, test, secure, observe and own.

The Agent Graveyard

Where “good” agents go when they never become important enough to keep.

GREAT DEMO

Looks impressive

SHIPPED

Never adopted

PRODUCTION

No meaningful shift

TECHNICALLY SOUND

Still optional

AUTOMATED

Wrong bottleneck

40%+ of agentic AI projects are forecast to be canceled by the end of 2027.

Built from capability • Detached from workflow • No meaningful business shift • No strategic anchor

Getting an AI system to production is only half the job.



Production proves viability. Value proves consequence.

The Build-Forward Default

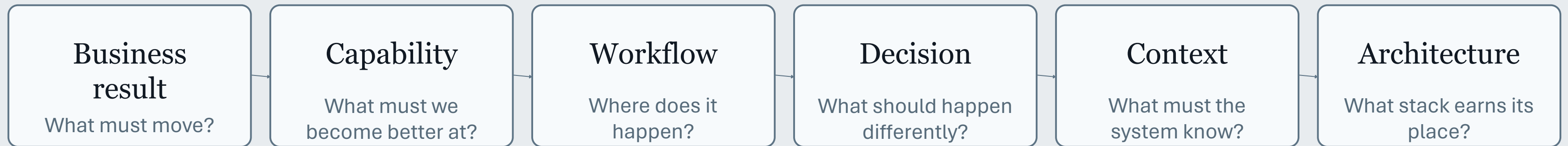
A request comes in. We start solutioning.



The tech stack becomes more apparent...but what about the business case?

Outcome Engineering

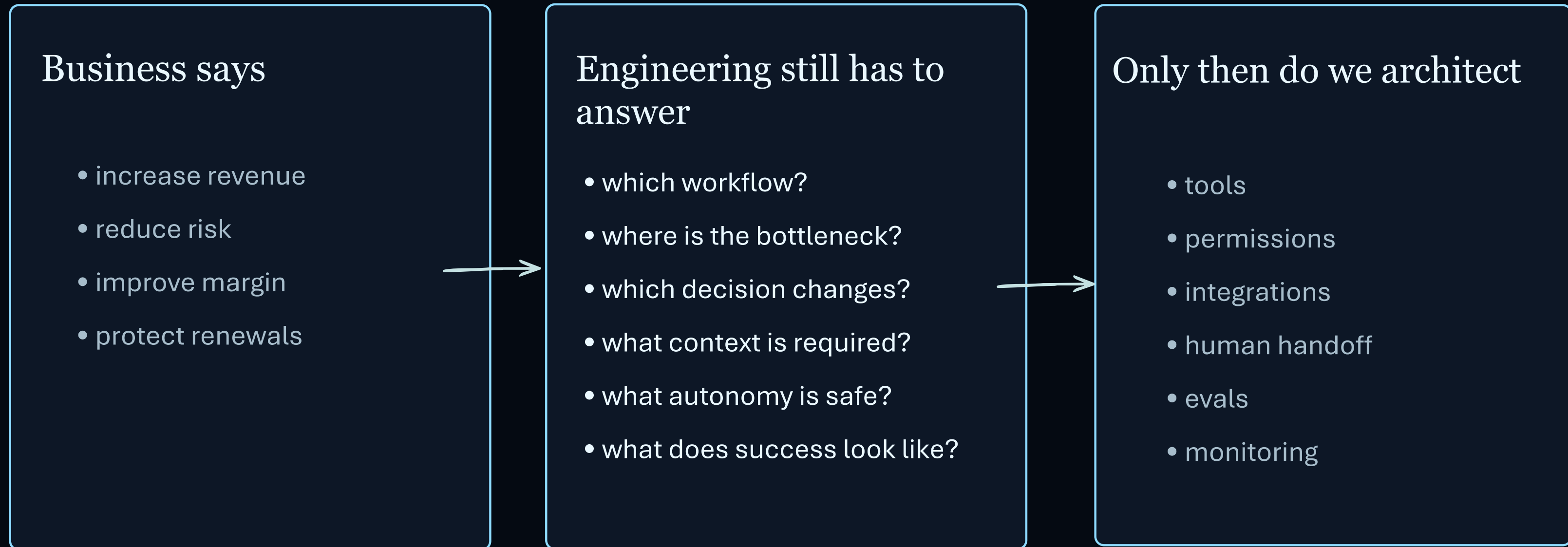
Start with the business result. Engineer backward from there.



By the time you choose a stack, you should already know what the stack is there to change for the business.

Where strategy becomes architecture

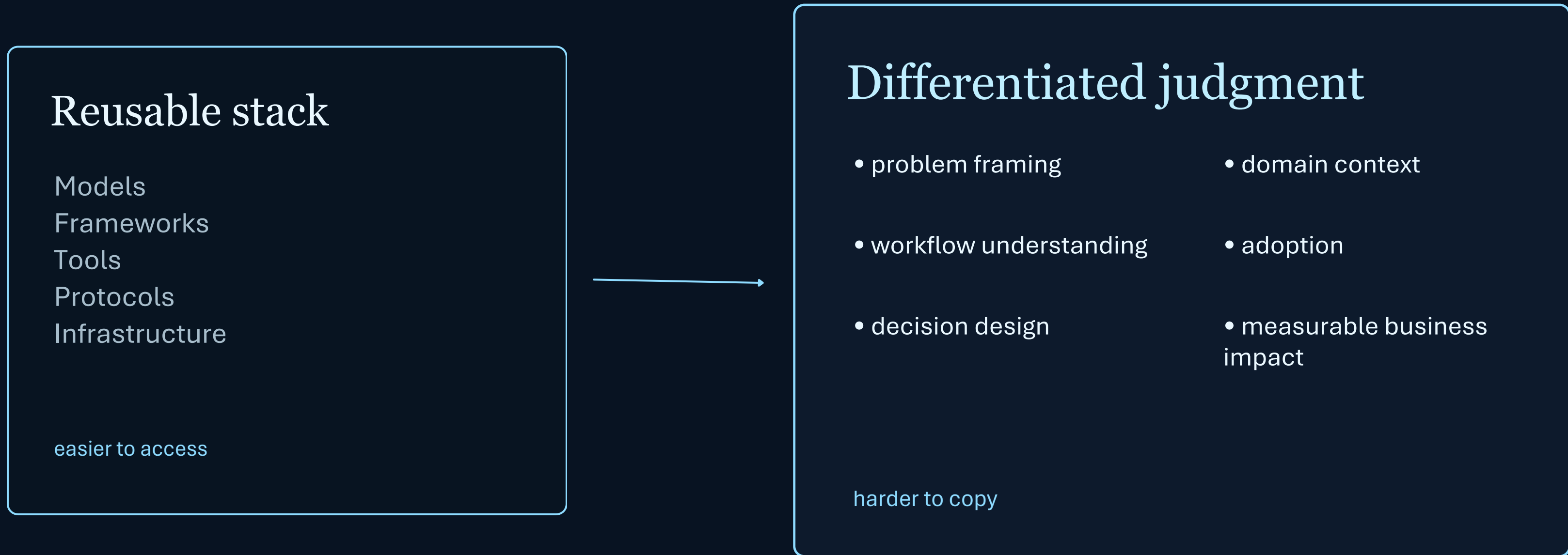
The missing work is turning business priorities into systems worth building.



When teams skip this strategy layer, the architecture gets clearer than the objective.

Where engineer value moves

As the stack gets easier to access, value moves **upstream**.



Durable advantage lives above the reusable stack.



Santiago  @svpino · 9/3/26



A buttload of developers are going through a tough time right now.

Their identity has always been tied to their ability to write code, so now they feel threatened by this new era where *anyone* can write code.

If they don't write code anymore, who are they?

I'm very pragmatic, and yet I've struggled with this too, so I totally understand how tough it must be for others.

You'll hear from these people everywhere. They are the ones fighting with everything they've got against AI-generated code.

But they must understand this is an uphill battle.

Manually writing code is destined to disappear. There's no going back.



If engineers don't write the code anymore, who are they?

Code is getting cheaper. Judgment is getting more valuable.

Your value increasingly follows the quality of your judgment and the importance of the problems you solve.

**The job is not protecting the mechanism.
It is protecting the outcome.**

The Outcome Engineer's Checklist

Questions to ask before you start architecting the solution.

- ✓ What outcome needs to move?
- ✓ What has to get better for the business
- ✓ Where is the actual bottleneck?
- ✓ What proprietary context does the system have?
- ✓ What part of the workflow controls that?
- ✓ Will this become harder to replace over time?

If shutting the system off would not make something important worse, it probably has not earned its place yet.

Don't architect the agent.

Architect the advantage.

Build systems so embedded in how the business wins that turning them off becomes a risk.



Kierra Dotson

Executive AI Advisor to Enterprise Leaders |
Turning AI Investment Into Enterprise Power,...

